

KIQ 1.3 — Final Answer

How do METRO's digital ordering channels contribute to customer retention, as reflected in repeat use, convenience, and loyalty signals?

Methodological note. Direct evidence (METRO app reviews) is out of course scope. SCOPUS literature is used as a proxy: the analysis reflects how scientific research structures retention concepts in digital commerce, not METRO's specific retention performance.

1. Core finding

Customer satisfaction sits at the structural center of the retention discourse, connecting service quality, customer experience, and trust on one side to customer loyalty and repurchase intention on the other. The retention chain *experience / service quality / trust* → *satisfaction* → *loyalty / repurchase intention* → *retention* is empirically supported by the network.

2. Strongest evidence

The thickest co-occurrences (satisfaction ↔ service quality, satisfaction ↔ loyalty, satisfaction ↔ repurchase intention) anchor this chain. *Convenience*, though named in the KIQ, does not appear as a standalone term — it manifests through service quality and customer experience, both of which the network confirms as central.

3. Periphery as bridge to KIT 2

Artificial intelligence, machine learning, CRM, information systems, and marketplaces sit at the edge of the network — connected to the core but not part of it. This is analytically meaningful: the literature treats these technologies as **enablers of retention mechanisms, not as retention drivers themselves**. AI and ML improve personalization and recommendation quality, which feed *customer experience*; CRM and information systems support *service quality* and *trust* through reliability and data continuity; marketplaces extend reach but depend on the same satisfaction-loyalty mechanics to retain users. In other words, technology amplifies the chain — it doesn't replace it. This sets up KIT 2 directly: the early-warning question is no longer *whether* AI-driven tools matter for retention, but *which* mechanisms in the chain they amplify most.

Bottom line

Scientific literature suggests digital commerce platforms retain customers primarily through satisfaction, sustained by service quality, trust, and customer experience, and expressed behaviorally as loyalty and repurchase intention. Emerging digital technologies appear as enabling layers around this core, not substitutes for it.